

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR
6 HOUSE BILL NO. 2210

By: Lay, **Hill**, and **Ranson** of
the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

11 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

12 An Act relating to career and technology education;
13 amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-127, which relates
14 to youth apprenticeship programs; modifying the
15 applicable age range; detailing when high school
16 students may begin the program; directing the
17 Department of Career and Technology Education to
18 oversee and implement the program; requiring
19 apprenticeship coordinators and describing their
20 duties; defining and requiring workplace mentors;
21 granting oversight to the Secretary of Education;
22 requiring certain reports; appropriating funds to
23 carry out the program; providing for noncodification;
24 and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-127, is
amended to read as follows:

1 Section 14-127. A. The Oklahoma Legislature, recognizing the
2 need for improved methods of helping ~~secondary students~~ youth
3 sixteen (16) to twenty-five (25) years of age make a ~~smooth~~
4 meaningful transition from high school to the workplace, hereby
5 establishes guidelines for youth apprenticeship programs. It shall
6 be the responsibility of the Oklahoma Department of Career and
7 Technology Education to establish a state-certified apprenticeship
8 program. The Board shall establish the rules to carry out the state
9 apprenticeship program.

10 B. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be defined as learning
11 programs for young people enrolled in vocational education that
12 combine ~~on-the-job~~ work-based learning with classroom instruction,
13 that offer a bridge between secondary and post high school training
14 and education, and that result in certification of mastery of work
15 skills.

16 C. A high school student may begin participation in an
17 apprenticeship beginning in the eleventh grade. Students who do not
18 begin participation during the eleventh grade may enter a pre-
19 apprenticeship or a full apprenticeship during the twelfth grade,
20 subject to employer need and program design. Students must be at
21 least sixteen (16) years of age to begin paid employment at a
22 workplace but related instruction may be completed before a student
23 turns sixteen (16) years of age. High school students who enter an
24 Oklahoma-certified apprenticeship program shall be given equal

1 credit to an Oklahoma CareerTech-approved full-time postsecondary
2 program.

3 D. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
4 shall fund apprenticeship coordinators. Apprenticeship coordinators
5 shall serve as the main liaison among school districts, industry
6 consortia, and hosting employers. Apprenticeship coordinators shall
7 also be responsible for guiding apprenticeship approval, providing
8 technical assistance to employers, site-based mentors, and school
9 districts, collecting site-level data on approved apprenticeships,
10 forming industry consortia, and chairing semi-annual industry
11 consortia meetings. Apprenticeship coordinators shall have a
12 caseload of apprenticeships to manage at their sites. After the
13 first year of operation, Oklahoma Department of Career and
14 Technology Education may move apprenticeship coordinators based on
15 varying local capacity for apprenticeships. The Oklahoma Department
16 of Career and Technology Education shall work to ensure that
17 apprenticeship opportunities are comparable in rural, suburban, and
18 urban areas.

19 E. A "workplace mentor" refers to an experienced employee who
20 provides direct supervision, instruction, and support for high
21 school apprentices, ensuring that an apprentice receives the skills
22 needed for a recognized credential and a clear pathway to full-time
23 employment in a skilled occupation. Each high school apprenticeship
24 shall have a site-based mentor.

1 F. The Secretary of Education shall provide statewide oversight
2 of all Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education-
3 approved high school apprenticeship programs. An annual report
4 shall be submitted to the Legislature that includes, but is not
5 limited to, the number of high school apprenticeships currently
6 enrolled, the number of high school apprenticeships completed, the
7 estimated return on investment of completed apprenticeships to the
8 state, and capacity differences across rural, suburban, and urban
9 areas of the state.

10 G. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
11 shall contract with an Oklahoma-based external evaluator or
12 Oklahoma-based university researcher to conduct a comprehensive
13 return on investment and impact evaluation of approved high school
14 apprenticeship programs. This report shall be submitted to the
15 Secretary of Education annually to inform the Secretary of
16 Education's annual report to the Legislature. This external
17 evaluation will be used to make annual funding determinations. The
18 cost of the evaluation shall not exceed Twelve Thousand Dollars
19 (\$12,000.00).

20 H. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be administered and
21 supervised by the State Board of Career and Technology Education,
22 which shall also establish standards for program operation.

23 ~~D.~~ I. Notwithstanding any other section of law, youth
24 apprenticeship programs shall not mean any traditional

1 apprenticeship program registered by the Bureau of Apprenticeship
2 and Training, United States Department of Labor.

3 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law not to be
4 codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:

5 There is hereby appropriated to the Oklahoma Department of
6 Career and Technology Education from any monies not otherwise
7 appropriated from the General Fund of the State Treasury for the
8 fiscal year ending June 30, 2027, the sum of Two Million Dollars
9 (\$2,000,000.00) or so much thereof as may be necessary to perform
10 the duties imposed upon the Oklahoma Department of Career and
11 Technology to carry out the youth apprenticeship program as directed
12 in Section 1 of this act.

13 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

14 SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
15 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
16 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
17 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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19 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION OVERSIGHT, dated
20 03/04/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended and Coauthored.
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